WEATHER APP

GitHub Upload & API-Key Safety Guide

A practical Windows + VS Code reference for publishing the existing React weather project to GitHub.

Goal: create a clean repository, push the project, and avoid accidentally publishing local dependencies or API credentials.

1. Before uploading

Your project is a React application. Git tracks project files, while GitHub hosts the repository online. A **.gitignore** file tells Git which untracked files to leave out; it does not remove files already tracked or erase old commits.

Recommended .gitignore entries

```
node_modules/\nbuild/\n.env\n.env.local\n.env.*.local\nnpm-debug.log*\n.DS_Store
```

Do not commit node_modules; it can be recreated with npm install. Do not commit a .env file containing your actual API key.

2. Create a new GitHub repository

1. Visit github.com/new and sign in.
2. Repository name: **weather-app** (or another name you prefer).
3. Add a description such as “A React weather application using the OpenWeather API.”
4. Choose Public or Private.
5. For an existing local project, leave the options to add a README, .gitignore, and license unchecked to avoid an initial-history conflict.
6. Click **Create repository** and copy the repository URL.

3. Open the project folder

Extract ETT.zip if needed. Open the extracted folder in VS Code. Select Terminal → New Terminal. Confirm the terminal is in the folder containing package.json.

```
node -v\nnpm -v\ngit --version
```

Each command should print a version. If Node.js or Git is missing, install it from the official websites and reopen the terminal.

4. Prepare and push the project

Run these commands one at a time from the project root. Replace YOUR-USERNAME with your GitHub username and use the exact repository URL GitHub shows.

```
git init\ngit status\ngit add .\ngit status\ngit commit -m "Initial commit: Weather App"\ngit
branch -M main\ngit remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/weather-app.git\ngit
push -u origin main
```

Before running git add ., inspect git status and ensure .env and node_modules are not listed for upload. If “remote origin already exists”, run git remote -v and use the existing URL or update it with git remote set-url origin YOUR_REPOSITORY_URL. If there is nothing to commit, check git status.

5. API-key safety

In src/App.js, use an environment variable rather than writing the key directly in source code:

```
const api_key = process.env.REACT_APP_OPENWEATHER_API_KEY;
```

Create a local file named .env beside package.json:

```
REACT_APP_OPENWEATHER_API_KEY=your_actual_api_key
```

Add .env to .gitignore. Restart npm start after changing environment variables. Never commit the real key or share it in screenshots/messages.

Important limitation: React environment variables are embedded into the client-side build. This keeps the key out of source files when handled correctly, but does not make it secret from users of a deployed app. Restrict the key where

possible, or use a backend proxy for stronger protection.

If the key was ever pushed to a public repository, changing the latest file does not erase it from Git history. Regenerate/revoke that key in the OpenWeather dashboard.

6. Updating GitHub later

```
git status\ngit add .\ngit commit -m "Describe your changes"\ngit push
```

Use these commands when uploading later changes. Check git status before committing.

Official resources

GitHub new repository: github.com/new
Node.js: nodejs.org/en/download
OpenWeather API keys: home.openweathermap.org/api_keys